

TENDER SPECIFICATIONS

FRAMEWORK CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF GEOSPATIAL PRODUCTS FOR THE COPERNICUS SECURITY SERVICE COMPONENT ON SUPPORT TO EU EXTERNAL AND SECURITY ACTIONS

SATCEN OP-05/26

ANNEX I TO THE INVITATION TO TENDER

< THIS PAGE IS INTENTIONALLY LEFT BLANK >

Contents

<u>1</u>	<u>INTRODUCTION</u>	<u>6</u>
1.1	DEFINITIONS	6
1.2	ACRONYMS	7
1.3	BACKGROUND	8
1.3.1	THE EUROPEAN UNION SATELLITE CENTRE	8
1.3.2	THE EU SPACE PROGRAMME AND COPERNICUS	8
1.3.3	THE COPERNICUS SESA SERVICE	9
1.4	OBJECTIVE OF THIS CALL FOR TENDERS	10
<u>2</u>	<u>TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS</u>	<u>11</u>
2.1	DESCRIPTION OF EXPECTED TASKS	11
2.1.1	EXPECTED TASKS UNDER THE FIXED PART OF THE CONTRACT	11
2.1.2	EXPECTED TASKS UNDER THE VARIABLE PART OF THE CONTRACT	12
2.2	TEAM RESPONSIBLE FOR THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE CONTRACT	13
2.3	MILESTONES AND MEETINGS	15
2.4	EXPECTED DELIVERABLES	16
2.4.1	DELIVERABLE D1 - SERVICE REPORTS	17
2.4.2	DELIVERABLE D2 - DELIVERABLES PER ORDER	17
2.4.3	DELIVERABLE D3 - TECHNICAL REPORTS	17
2.4.4	DELIVERABLE D4 – INTERMEDIATE PROGRESS REPORT	18
2.4.5	DELIVERABLE D5 – FINAL PROGRESS REPORT	18
2.4.6	DELIVERABLE D6 – ANNUAL INVENTORY LIST	18
2.4.7	DELIVERABLE D7 – AD-HOC REPORTS	18
2.4.8	COMMUNICATION CHANNELS	18
<u>3</u>	<u>CONTRACTUAL TERMS</u>	<u>19</u>
3.1	NATURE OF THE CONTRACT	19
3.2	ENTRY INTO FORCE AND DURATION OF THE CONTRACT	19
3.3	PLACE OF PERFORMANCE	19
3.4	CONTRACT VALUE	20
3.5	OWNERSHIP OF THE RESULTS OF THE FWC	20
<u>4</u>	<u>EVALUATION OF TENDERS</u>	<u>21</u>

4.1	STAGES OF THE EVALUATION	21
4.2	ACCESS TO PROCUREMENT	21
4.2.1	REQUIREMENT	21
4.2.2	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	22
4.3	EXCLUSION CRITERIA	22
4.3.1	REQUIREMENT	22
4.3.2	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	22
4.4	COMPLIANCE WITH ENVIRONMENTAL, SOCIAL AND LABOUR LAWS	23
4.4.1	REQUIREMENT	23
4.4.2	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	23
4.5	SELECTION STAGE	23
4.5.1	LEGAL CAPACITY	24
4.5.2	ECONOMIC AND FINANCIAL CAPACITY	24
4.5.3	TECHNICAL AND PROFESSIONAL CAPACITY	25
4.6	MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS	26
4.6.1	MINIMUM LEVEL OF QUALIFICATIONS AND EXPERIENCE OF THE PROPOSED TEAM MEMBERS	26
4.6.2	MINIMUM TECHNICAL EQUIPMENT	30
4.7	AWARD CRITERIA	31
4.7.1	TECHNICAL EVALUATION	31
4.7.2	FINANCIAL EVALUATION	33
4.7.3	AWARD (RANKING OF TENDERS)	36
<u>5</u>	<u>ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION CONCERNING THE INVITATION TO TENDER</u>	<u>37</u>
5.1	APPLICABLE RULES	37
5.2	NO OBLIGATION TO AWARD	37
5.3	MISREPRESENTATION AND CORRUPTIVE PRACTICES	37
5.4	TENDER CALENDAR	38
5.5	SUBCONTRACTING	38
5.6	PARTICIPATION OF CONSORTIA	39
5.7	EU FUNDING	40
5.8	OPPORTUNITIES FOR SMALL AND MEDIUM SIZED ENTERPRISES	40
5.9	SUBSEQUENT CONTRACTS WITH THE SAME CONTRACTOR	40
<u>6</u>	<u>SUBMISSION VIA THE E-SUBMISSION APPLICATION</u>	<u>41</u>

7 APPENDICES

46

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Definitions

The terms and acronyms below, appearing either in a complete or in an abbreviated form, when used in this document and its annexes, the Invitation to Tender and the Draft Framework Contract, shall be understood to have the following meaning:

- **Activation:** The process comprising the initiation, performance of the Service and delivery of Service products per Order.
- **Contractor:** The Economic Operator in charge of providing the Services, after successfully tendering and signing the Framework Contract.
- **Contracting Authority:** The SatCen, acting as the authority awarding the Framework Contract under EU procurement rules.
- **Consortium:** A grouping of eligible Economic Operators created under a consortium agreement for the specific purpose of bidding for the Framework Contract.
- **Consortium Leader:** One of the Economic Operators forming the Consortium, elected by all the Consortium members for the purposes of submitting the tender, signing the Framework Contract, acting as an interface with the Contracting Authority and making binding commitments on behalf of the Consortium and its members.
- **Deliverables:** Outputs generated during the implementation of the Framework Contract and its Activations, which may include, inter alia, documents, maps as hard-copies (digital) and geospatial information products, in different formats (as specified in Appendix A - Technical Specifications I and Appendix B –Technical Specifications II (limited distribution)).
- **Economic Operator:** Any natural or legal person or public entity or group of such persons and/or entities, including any temporary association of undertakings, which offers the execution of works and/or a work, the supply of products or the provision of services on the market.
- **Entrusted Entity:** The SatCen, acting as the entity designated by the European Commission under the Contribution Agreement for the provision of Copernicus Security Service component on Support to EU External and Security Actions.
- **European Union Satellite Centre:** The SatCen.
- **Framework Contract:** The Contract governing the rights and obligations between the SatCen and the Contractor for the provision of the Service and the supply of Products and establishing the terms and conditions applicable to Service Requests and Orders.
- **Group:** Two or more enterprises are considered to belong to the same group if they function as a single economic entity through a common source of control. Control means having the power to appoint the majority of directors or to approve the budget or the business plan, by holding a majority of the voting rights in the management board.
- **Information and data:** Means any drawings, specifications, photographs, samples, models, processes, procedures, instructions, software, reports, papers, or any other technical and/or commercial information, know how, data or documents of any kind, including oral information, other than Intellectual Property Rights.

- **Order(s):** Binding request(s) placed by the Contracting Authority to the Contractor under the terms of the Framework Contract for the provision of products relating to the Variable Part of the Framework Contract.
- **Pre-existing rights:** Any industrial and intellectual property rights, including background technology, which exist prior to the Contracting Authority, or the Contractor ordering them for the purpose of the Contract performance and include rights of ownership and use by the Contractor, the creator, the Contracting Authority and any other third parties.
- **Products:** The different types of outputs that, in the frame of this Framework Contract, the Contracting Authority can request from the Contractor, as defined in Appendix A - Technical Specifications I.
- **Reports:** Information derived from the coordination and managerial activities, including documents, financial sheets and equivalent information.
- **Result(s):** Any intended outcome resulting from the implementation of the contract, whatever its form or nature (tangible and intangible assets, in particular data and information products or software products). A Result may, in addition to newly created materials produced specifically for the Contracting Authority by the Contractor or at its request, also include pre-existing materials.
- **Service:** The on-demand services required for the production of deliverable geospatial products resulting from the analysis of satellite imagery and collateral data.
- **Service Request(s):** Binding request(s) placed by the Contracting Authority to the Contractor under the terms of the Framework Contract for the provision of services relating to the Fixed Part of the Framework Contract.
- **Small and Medium Enterprise (SME):** An enterprise which employs fewer than 250 persons and which has either an annual turnover not exceeding 50 million Euro, or an annual balance sheet not exceeding 43 million Euro, according to the European Commission Recommendation, of 6 May 2003, concerning the definition of micro, small and medium-sized enterprises (OJ L 124 of 20.05.2003, p.36).
- **Subcontracting:** The situation where a contract has been or is to be established between the SatCen and a Contractor and where the Contractor, in order to carry out that contract, enters into legal commitments with other legal entities for performing part of the service.

1.2 Acronyms

The following table lists the acronyms used throughout this Annex and its associated Appendices.

Acronym	Complete Name
AOI	Area Of Interest
BN	Briefing Note
CCM	Copernicus Contributing Missions
CEFR	Common European Framework of Reference for Languages
CFSP	Common Foreign and Security Policy
CMC	Country Map Coverage
CSDP	Common Security and Defence Policy
DEM	Digital Elevation Model

DGI	Digital Geographic Information
EO	Earth Observation
EQF	European Qualifications Framework
ESA	European Space Agency
EU	European Union
FIR	First Impression Report
FS	Financial Score
FWC	Framework Contract
GIS	Geographic Information Systems
HR	High Resolution
IMINT	Imagery Intelligence
IIRC	Input Imagery Resolution Class
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
OSINT	Open-source intelligence
QC	Quality Control
QS	Quality Score
SAR	Synthetic Aperture Radar
SESA	Support to EU External and Security Actions
SME	Small and Medium Enterprise
SFTP	Secure File Transfer Protocol
VHR	Very High Resolution

1.3 Background

1.3.1 The European Union Satellite Centre

According to Council Decision 2014/401/CFSP, of 26 June 2014, on the European Union Satellite Centre (SatCen), the SatCen's mission is to support the decision making and actions of the Union in the field of the Common Foreign and Security Policy (CFSP) and in particular the Common Security and Defence Policy (CSDP), including European Union crisis management missions and operations, by providing, at the request of the Council or the High Representative (HR) of the Union for Foreign Affairs and Security Policy, products and services resulting from the exploitation of relevant space assets and collateral data, including satellite and aerial imagery, and related services.

The SatCen is a decentralised agency of the EU working under the supervision of the Political and Security Committee and the operational direction of the HR. The SatCen was founded in 1992 as a Western European Union body and incorporated as an agency into the EU on 1 January 2002.

The seat of the SatCen is Torrejón de Ardoz, Madrid, Spain, as established in Article 1(3) of Council Decision 2014/401/CFSP, of 26 June 2014, on the European Union Satellite Centre.

Further information can be found on the SatCen's website: <https://www.satcen.europa.eu>.

1.3.2 The EU Space Programme and Copernicus

Copernicus is one of the components of the EU Space Programme for the period 2021-2027, as set out in Regulation (EU) 2021/696 of the European Parliament and the Council, of 28 April 2021, establishing

the Union Space Programme and the European Union Agency for the Space Programme and repealing Regulations (EU) No 912/2010, (EU) No 1285/2013 and (EU) No 377/2014 and Decision No 541/2014/EU¹ (the “EU Space Programme Regulation”).

Copernicus is the leading provider of (EO) data, which is used for services providers, public authorities and other international organisations to improve the quality of life for the European citizens.

The Copernicus services transform satellite and in-situ data into value-added information by processing and analysing the data. Datasets stretching back for years and decades are made comparable and searchable, thus ensuring the monitoring of changes; patterns are examined and used to create better forecasts. Maps are created from imagery, features and anomalies are identified and statistical information is extracted.

These value-adding activities are streamlined through six thematic streams of Copernicus services: land, marine, atmosphere, climate change, emergency management, and security. Specifically, the Copernicus Security Service is dedicated to supporting European Union policies by providing valuable information to address security challenges. With a focus on crisis prevention, preparedness, and response capacities, the service operates in key areas such as:

- (i) Support to EU External and Security Actions.
- (ii) Maritime Surveillance.
- (iii) Border Surveillance.

The Copernicus Security Service reinforces Europe's commitment to promoting stability, human rights, democracy, and fundamental freedoms, while mitigating risks and supporting security-related initiatives.

Further information on Copernicus can be found at <https://eu-space.europa.eu/programmes/earth-observation-copernicus>.

1.3.3 The Copernicus SESA Service

The European Commission has entrusted the SatCen with the management of the Copernicus Security service component on Support to EU External and Security Actions (the “Copernicus SESA Service”). The Copernicus SESA Service is a European geospatial information service that assists the EU and its Member States by enhancing situational awareness needed by institutional stakeholders working in security-related domains. It provides geospatial products covering users’ information needs and requirements related to EU External Action, security challenges facing the EU and its Member States as well as monitoring of the implementation of EU Law.

The Application Areas of SESA include Security of EU Citizens, Humanitarian Aid, Crisis and Conflict, Rule of Law, Transport Safety and Security, Stability and Resilience for Development, Cultural Heritage, Environmental Compliance, Climate Security, International Trade and Economic Diplomacy and Health Security.

The Copernicus SESA Service is the continuation of the Copernicus Service in Support to EU External Action (the Copernicus SEA service).

¹ OJEU L 170/69, 12-05-2021

Further details on the Copernicus SESA Service can be found on its website at <https://sesa.security.copernicus.eu/>.

1.4 Objective of this call for tenders

The objective of this procurement procedure is to conclude a Framework Contract (hereinafter the “FWC” or the “Contract”) with a single economic operator for the production and supply of geospatial products for the Copernicus Security Service Component on Support to EU External and Security Actions (hereinafter “the Copernicus SESA Service”).

The services to be delivered under the FWC shall consist of the production and supply of geospatial information products derived from the analysis of (EO data and relevant collateral sources). These products are intended to support situational awareness and decision-making processes in the context of EU external action and security-related activities.

The Copernicus SESA Service operates as a user-driven and demand-based service. As such, the nature, scope, geographic coverage and volume of requested products may vary significantly over time depending on evolving user needs and operational priorities. The Contracting Authority does not guarantee any minimum volume of requests under the FWC.

The implementation of the FWC is structured around:

- A **fixed part**, covering the continuous provision, coordination and management of the service.
- A **variable part**, covering the on-demand production and delivery of geospatial products in response to Orders issued by the Contracting Authority.

The Contractor shall ensure the capacity to respond effectively to varying demand levels and to adapt production workflows to different operational contexts and requirements.

The execution of the FWC shall be based on Service Requests and Orders issued by the Contracting Authority and implemented by the Contractor. The Contracting Authority may modify and add value to the Products delivered by the Contractor where necessary.

The detailed description of the tasks, roles, responsibilities and performance requirements applicable to both the fixed and variable parts of the Contract is provided in Section 2.1.

The SatCen is proposing a draft FWC, enclosed as Annex II to the Invitation to Tender. The Contract gives rise to no direct obligation for the Contracting Authority. Only the signature of Service Requests and Orders by both contracting parties creates a legal obligation. The signature of the FWC does not impose any obligation on the Contracting Authority to place Service Requests or Orders.

This procurement procedure is not divided into lots. The Tenderer must be able to provide all services requested under the Contract.

2 TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

2.1 Description of expected tasks

The expected tasks under the FWC are structured into two complementary components:

- **Fixed part:** Covers all the tasks relating to availability of the production team, project management and coordination of tasks. The SatCen estimates these services to be provided in a continuous and stable manner, in periods ranging from three (3) to six (6) months, throughout the whole term of the FWC, including its possible renewals, by means of Service Requests placed by the SatCen.
- **Variable part:** Includes all varying tasks relating to the production and supply of geospatial Products, at the request of the SatCen via Order Forms based on evolving users' needs.

In order to perform the variable and fixed tasks of the FWC, the Contractor shall ensure the availability of a specific team dedicated to the fixed part and the variable part, respectively, with the profiles, roles, functions and dedication described in Section 2.2.

It is expected that the experts responsible for the execution of the FWC will remain bound to the performance of the Service during the lifetime of the FWC. Any replacement of a team member during the execution of the FWC shall only be made with the prior written approval of the Contracting Authority. The proposed substitute(s) will have to fulfil the same minimum requirements indicated in Section 4.6.1.

2.1.1 Expected tasks under the fixed part of the Contract

The tasks under the fixed part of the Contract include:

- **Availability:** The Contractor must ensure the continuous availability of a dedicated team to fulfil all necessary tasks related to the geospatial production, management and coordination. The team must be available twelve (12) hours a day (from 8:00 h to 20:00 h CET), seven (7) days a week, for receiving SatCen's Orders for geospatial Products.
- **Coordination with the Contracting Authority:** The Contractor is expected to maintain a permanent dialogue with the Contracting Authority in order to ensure the correct implementation of the Service. This task involves the organisation of (formal and informal) meetings with the Contracting Authority, to report on the performance of the Service and potential incidents. Two types of meetings may be requested: technical and/or managerial.
- **Contract Management:** The envisaged activities comprise managerial, administrative, legal and financial tasks including invoicing. The Project Manager selected by the Contractor will be in charge of these tasks. In his/her absence, the Project Manager will be substituted by the Deputy Project Manager.
- **Management of the orders:** This task includes the reception of Orders, the acknowledgement of receipt, the analysis of Orders for further coordination and their activation. The Contractor shall acknowledge receipt and begin working on the Orders within a maximum period of four (4) hours from the reception of the Order (unless otherwise specified).
- **Internal technical coordination:** This task includes the activation of production and the coordination of the technical work within the production team in order to balance the workload.
- **Homogeneity of the products:** This task includes the coordination of the technical work within the production team in order to ensure consistency and homogeneity among products. The

Technical Point of Contact will guarantee the homogeneity in all production scenarios, including the production of several products (e.g. FIRs) that could be generated in parallel or the production of a large product (e.g. DGI).

- **Technical coordination with the Contracting Authority:** This task covers the communication with the Contracting Authority for the technical monitoring of the provision of products, informing on the production progress, as well as potential incidents and unforeseen events.
- **Quality management:** this task consists in the continuous monitoring of the production chain, from start to end, while ensuring that the production guidelines and topological rules are appropriately applied. Quality Management will ensure the accomplishment of the technical requirements and quality standards and the adequate implementation of mitigation and corrective plans. Additionally, under the quality management activities, the Contractor will provide the Contracting Authority with quality reports.
- **Reporting:** The Contractor will provide the Contracting Authority with several reports, describing the Service performance during the reporting period.

2.1.2 Expected tasks under the variable part of the Contract

The production and supply of Products under the variable part of the Contract comprise the tasks described in the following sub-section.

2.1.2.1 Product types

The variable part of the Contract covers the on-demand production and supply of the following Product Types, as requested through Orders placed by the Contracting Authority.

The FWC covers the production of five (5) Product Types:

- First Impression Report (FIR).
- Briefing Note (BN).
- Digital Geographic Information (DGI).
- Mapbook (MB).
- Country Map Coverage (CMC).

The technical characteristics, content, structure and production requirements of each Product Type are defined in Appendix A - Technical Specifications I.

Due to the specific operational context of the Copernicus SESA service, certain technical documentation (Appendix B - Technical Specifications II (limited distribution)) forming part of the procurement documents is not publicly accessible. **Economic operators interested in participating in this procurement procedure may request access to Appendix B by submitting the Non-Disclosure Undertaking** provided in Appendix K, duly filled in, dated and signed, to procurement.satcen@satcen.europa.eu.

The methodology for the calculation of price and production time applicable to each Product Type, including any applicable correcting factors or coefficients, is defined in Appendix D - Calculation of the Total Price and Production Time of Orders, and is based on the reference prices set out in Appendix C - Economic Offer.

To fulfil the Orders placed under the variable part of the Contract, the Contractor shall demonstrate the technical capacity to perform geospatial production activities including, inter alia:

- Pre-processing and processing of EO imagery, as required by the Product specifications.
- Visual interpretation and analysis of imagery for the identification of relevant activities, features and/or changes.

- Extraction and structuring of geospatial data in accordance with the applicable data model and specifications.
- Basic and advanced geospatial analysis and raster/vector processing techniques.
- Integration of collateral and ancillary data from open or other authorised sources.
- Generation of cartographic outputs and/or intelligence-oriented analytical reports.

The list above is indicative and non-exhaustive. The Contractor shall perform all technical activities necessary to meet the requirements defined in Appendix A - Technical Specifications I and Appendix B - Technical Specifications II (limited distribution).

A specific geospatial production team shall be dedicated to the variable tasks, with the minimum composition and profiles described in Section 2.2.

2.2 Team responsible for the implementation of the Contract

The Contract shall be implemented by a team of geospatial production experts, with the profiles, minimum composition and roles indicated below:

- One (1) **Project Manager**, ultimately responsible for the Service performance, including the supervision of all the operational aspects, team management and communication with SatCen, management of contractual aspects and due provision of deliverables.
- One (1) **Deputy Project Manager**, fulfilling the same tasks as the Project Manager during its absence.
- Two (2) **Production Coordinators**, responsible for managing all the technical aspects and the production team. The Production Coordinator receives and handles the order, plans and coordinates the production effort and supervises that production is progressing according to the estimated calendar in order to avoid any possible delay in delivery. Furthermore, the Production Coordinators should harmonise the product before delivery.
- One (1) **Quality Assurance Manager**, responsible for monitoring the end-to-end production workflow and ensuring that the highest quality level is met at all stages. The Quality Assurance Manager is responsible for accurate and proper implementation of the Quality Management Plan through all the Service. In case of detecting any non-conformity, he/she is responsible for implementing any corrective measure required.
- One (1) **Earth Observation Specialist**, responsible for image processing tasks, including among others, pre-processing and processing EO data. The expert should be able to perform advanced remote sensing processing, such as multi-source data fusion, object-based image classification and multi-temporal analysis based on time-series involving a high number of images.
- One (1) **GIS Analyst**, responsible for the creation and maintenance of geospatial databases, management of geospatial datasets, preparation and generation of geospatial outputs and developing GIS analytical methods.
- One (1) **Quality Control Supervisor**, responsible for applying evaluation and verification checks in order to ensure the homogeneity, completeness, logical consistency and positional and thematic accuracy of data produced and final products to be delivered.
- Six (6) **Imagery Analysts**, responsible for image interpretation and extraction of vector data from satellite imagery and generation of cartographic products.

The minimum dedication to the FWC of the team members shall be as indicated below:

Profile type	Required minimum dedication to the FWC per profile
Project Manager (or Deputy Project Manager in his/her absence)	50 %
Production Coordinator	100 %
Quality Assurance Manager	50 %
Earth Observation Specialist	100 %
GIS Analyst	100 %
Quality Control Supervisor	100 %
Imagery Analyst	100 %

Table 1 Required minimum dedication to the FWC per profile

For the fixed part of the Contract, the Contractor shall appoint from the proposed team members, at least a Project Manager and a Technical Point of Contact, with the roles and responsibilities described below:

1. **Project Manager.** The Project Manager shall be designated by the Contractor to act as unique interface with the Contracting Authority regarding managerial, administrative, legal and financial tasks including invoicing. Additionally, the Project Manager shall be responsible at all times for the provision of Deliverables and reports.

The Project Manager shall be available by telephone or e-mail eight (8) hours a day during office working days. Where the Project Manager is unable to perform his/her duties, the Project Manager shall be replaced by another person with equivalent qualifications. Such person shall be identified in the Tender as the **Deputy Project Manager**. A prior written request for the replacement of the Project Manager or the Deputy Project Manager shall be submitted to the Contracting Authority, along with a proposal for a substitute.

The Project Manager shall respond to all requests and queries raised by the Contracting Authority within the following time limits:

- Requests regarding management, administrative and financial issues must be responded within a maximum of two (2) working days.
 - The Project Manager shall be available to hold a telephone conversation during working hours, within four (4) hours from the Contracting Authority's request.
2. **Technical Point of Contact (TPoC).** The Technical Point of Contact shall be appointed by the Contractor to act as focal point for all aspects related to production, including confirmation of Orders' reception, clarifications requested by the Contracting Authority either during the placement of the order or during the validation process (undertaken by the Contracting Authority), delivery of products, reporting on Service status and process and any potential doubt or incidence that may arise.

The TPoC shall be available twelve (12) hours a day (from 8:00 to 20:00 h CET), seven (7) days a week, during the whole duration of the Contract, via email and telephone. Additionally, technical issues during on-going orders shall be managed immediately.

The same person cannot act simultaneously as the Project Manager and the TPoC.

The Project Manager shall be responsible for both the fixed part and the variable part of the Contract.

The TPoC may be any member of the production team (e.g. Production Coordinators).

2.3 Milestones and meetings

Considering the activities to be performed during the FWC, four milestones are foreseen, corresponding to the accomplishment of fundamental FWC tasks. The table below provides the basic information related to these milestones (ID, objectives, related tasks, and associated months).

ID	Milestone Meeting Name	Objective	Related Tasks	Tentative Dates ²
M1	FWC Kick-Off	Start of the FWC	Fixed and Variable parts	T0 ³ + 1 month
M2	Set-up phase	Aiming at aligning the Contractor's workflow and production capacities with the requirements of these Tender Specifications and defining communication channels and the operational arrangements for the secure delivery of Deliverables between the Contractor and the Contracting Authority. It will end once both parties have reached an agreement on all relevant items, but this process cannot exceed 1 month.	Fixed and Variable parts	T0 + 1 month
M3	Intermediate Review	Aiming at monitoring the Service progress and performance at a managerial level, and it will be completed after the Contracting Authority receives the Intermediate Progress Report. A meeting may be organized between the Project Manager (Contractor) and the Service Coordinator (Contracting Authority). A positive evaluation is fundamental for the renewal of the FWC.	Fixed and Variable parts	T0 + 9 months
M4	Final Review	It aims at monitoring the Service progress and performance at a managerial level, and it will be completed when the Contracting	Fixed and Variable parts	T0 + 18 months

² To be further defined in the set-up phase and/or during the implementation of the Contract.

³ T0 will be considered as the date of entry into force of the FWC.

		Authority receives the Final Progress Report. A meeting may be organised between the Project Manager (Contractor) and the Service Coordinator (Contracting Authority).		
--	--	---	--	--

Table 2 List of milestones and meetings

Additionally, the following meetings are envisaged to facilitate the discussions between the Contractor and the Contracting Authority.

Additional Meeting Name	Objective	Related Task	Tentative dates
Technical Workshops	A maximum of two technical workshops per year may be organized to monitor the progress and performance of the Service at the technical level. These Workshops may be requested by the Contracting Authority depending on the progress of the Service.	Variable part	On demand, with a maximum of three for the whole duration of the FWC
Ad-hoc Technical Meetings	The Contracting Authority may request ad-hoc technical meetings with the Contractor (more specifically, with the Technical Point of Contact) regarding specific needs of ongoing activations if deemed necessary. Technical Meetings may be held at the Contractor's request with the prior approval of the Contracting Authority.	Variable part	On demand

Table 3 List of additional meetings

The Contractor shall be responsible for taking minutes of all meetings. The minutes of these meetings will be submitted by the Contractor at the latest within five (5) working days after the meeting for SatCen's approval.

The specific dates and location of the meetings will be agreed between the Contractor and the Contracting Authority. These meetings will be held at SatCen premises or by remote means (e.g. Microsoft Teams, Webex, etc.). In addition, the Contractor shall be available to organise meetings at its own premises, if requested by the Contracting Authority.

In addition to the above-mentioned meetings, the Contracting Authority will have regular contacts and interactions with the Contractor to monitor the implementation of the FWC.

2.4 Expected deliverables

During the term of the FWC, the Contractor shall submit a set of expected deliverables to the Contracting Authority. The list in the table below is defined in accordance with the milestones and the

foreseen meetings. The deliverables are considered as key documents to be provided by the Contractor.

The language of all deliverables shall be English.

The deliverables and their indicative submission timing are set out below:

ID	Deliverable Name	Related Task	Deadline for submission
D1	Service Reports	Fixed part	Five (5) working days from the termination of the period.
D2	Deliverables per order	Variable part	As defined in the Orders
D3	Technical Reports	Variable Part	Five (5) working days from the Production Closure ⁴
D4	Intermediate Progress Report	Fixed and Variable parts	On demand
D5	Final Progress Report	Fixed and Variable parts	On demand
D6	Annual Inventory List	Fixed and Variable parts	On demand
D7	Ad-hoc Reports	Fixed and Variable parts	On demand

Table 4 List of expected deliverables

2.4.1 Deliverable D1 - Service Reports

During the period covered by each Service Request, the Contractor shall ensure the performance of the tasks corresponding to the fixed part of the FWC at the required level of performance, reactivity, proactivity and professionalism, including all availability, communication, managerial and coordination tasks.

At the end of each Service Request period, the Contractor shall prepare a Service Report summarising the activities performed during that period. Activities relating to the maintenance of the Service shall also be reflected, where relevant, in the corresponding Progress Reports. The final structure and detailed content of the Service Reports shall be agreed during the Set-Up Phase. Service Reports shall be concise and should preferably not exceed five (5) pages.

2.4.2 Deliverable D2 - Deliverables per Order

For each Order, the Contractor shall produce and submit all Products and associated materials required under the variable part of the FWC. These deliverables shall include, as applicable, the Product in specified format and project files, associated geodatabases, original and processed imagery, quality control reports, and any other materials required for the relevant product type. The detailed technical characteristics, content, structure and associated materials are defined in both Appendix A - Technical Specifications I and Appendix B - Technical Specifications II (limited distribution).

2.4.3 Deliverable D3 - Technical Reports

For each Order, the Contractor shall prepare a Technical Report documenting the specific activities performed for the relevant Activation. The Technical Report shall include, at a minimum, a summary of EO data and non-EO data used for the Activation, an overview of the Order, and a summary of the outputs delivered. The final structure and detailed content of the Technical Report shall be agreed during the Set-Up Phase. Each Technical Report shall not exceed ten (10) pages.

⁴ For further information on the Service Workflow refer to Section 7 of Appendix A – Technical Specifications I.

2.4.4 Deliverable D4 – Intermediate Progress Report

The Contractor shall prepare an Intermediate Progress Report covering the implementation and performance of the Service during the relevant reporting period. This report shall include, at a minimum, a summary of the activities carried out by the Contractor, managerial reporting and technical reporting. The final structure and content of the Intermediate Progress Report shall be agreed during the set-up phase. This report shall not exceed twenty (20) pages.

A positive evaluation of this Deliverable is fundamental for the renewal of the FWC.

2.4.5 Deliverable D5 – Final Progress Report

The Contractor shall prepare a Final Progress Report covering the implementation and performance of the Service during the relevant reporting period. This report shall include, at a minimum, a summary of the activities carried out by the Contractor, managerial reporting, and technical reporting, and shall provide a comprehensive analysis of the work performed during the reporting period. The final structure and content of the Final Progress Report shall be agreed during the set-up phase. No page limitation shall apply to the Final Progress Report.

2.4.6 Deliverable D6 – Annual Inventory List

The Contractor shall maintain an inventory of all Results produced and acquired in the performance of the FWC, including those produced under Orders and Service Requests. Upon request of the Contracting Authority, made with reasonable prior notice and in accordance with the principle of proportionality, the Contractor shall provide an annual inventory list covering the year N-1, as well as, where requested, the entire period of the FWC.

The Inventory List shall include, at a minimum:

- The list of patents, licences and other registered intellectual property rights.
- The list of deliverable documentation.

2.4.7 Deliverable D7 – Ad-hoc Reports

The Contractor shall prepare ad-hoc reports whenever requested by the Contracting Authority in relation to the implementation of the tasks under the FWC. Such reports shall contain the additional information requested by the Contracting Authority and shall be structured in accordance with the purpose and scope of the request.

2.4.8 Communication channels

Communication, information exchange and acceptance of Deliverables between SatCen and the Contractor shall take place by email or through the communication channels agreed during the set-up phase.

3 CONTRACTUAL TERMS

3.1 Nature of the Contract

The FWC will be implemented via Service Requests and Orders, for both the fixed part and the variable part respectively, in accordance with the terms of the FWC.

Tenderers attention is drawn to the fact that the signature of the FWC does not constitute the placement of a Service Request nor an Order, but is merely designed to set up the legal, financial, technical, and administrative terms governing the commercial relations between SatCen and the Contractor during FWC implementation.

Signature of the FWC imposes no obligation on the Contracting Authority to acquire services or place Service Requests or Orders and does not give the Contractor any exclusive rights to the provision of the services covered by the FWC.

The Services under the fixed part of the Contract and the Products under the variable part of the Contract will be requested by SatCen via Service Requests and Orders, according to the Order Form and Service Request Form templates included in Annex II to the Invitation to tender - Draft framework contract.

Only the signature of a Service Request or an Order by both contracting parties is binding on the SatCen and gives rise to a legal obligation to purchase. In any case, SatCen reserves the right, at any time during the term of FWC, to cease placing Service Requests and Orders without the Contractor thereby having the right to any compensation.

3.2 Entry into force and duration of the Contract

The FWC shall enter into force on 1 January 2027, provided it has been signed by both contracting parties. The implementation of the FWC cannot start before its entry in force.

The FWC is concluded for a period of twelve (12) months from the date of its entry into force

The FWC is renewed automatically one (1) time for a period of six (6) months, unless one of the parties receives formal notification to the contrary at least three (3) months before the end of the ongoing duration. Renewal does not change or postpone any existing obligations.

The whole period of implementation of the FWC shall not exceed eighteen (18) months.

3.3 Place of Performance

The Services shall be mainly provided at the Contractor's premises. Notwithstanding the foregoing, at the request of the Contracting Authority, the Contractor may perform certain tasks at the SatCen premises, including, without limitation, attendance at the Kick-Off meeting and review meetings.

The Contractor shall be available to organise meetings at its own premises, if requested by SatCen.

3.4 Contract Value

The maximum Contract value is six million ninety thousand Euros (€6,090,000.00), excluding VAT, during the whole period of validity of the FWC, including possible renewals. However, this does not bind the Contracting Authority to purchase for the maximum amount.

3.5 Ownership of the Results of the FWC

The European Union, represented by the European Commission, shall be the direct and sole owner of intellectual property rights on all the Results resulting from the performance of the FWC, as from the moment the Contractor has created such Results.

The Contractor waives any intellectual property rights over the Results of the FWC, including the rights to use and disseminate these Results. If applicable, the Contractor shall ensure such a waiver from its subcontractors.

The European Union shall not acquire ownership of any pre-existing rights. All pre-existing rights shall be licensed to the European Union. Any such licenses of pre-existing rights shall be royalty-free, non-exclusive, worldwide and irrevocable and must cover all acts necessary for the use of the Results by the European Union as envisaged in the EU Space Programme.

The Contractor warrants that the exclusive rights and the modes of exploitation described in the FWC may be exercised by the European Union on all parts of the Results, be it via a transfer of ownership of the rights, on those parts which were specifically created by the Contractor, or via a license of the pre-existing rights, on those parts consisting of pre-existing materials.

The Contractor must ensure to have secured all the licenses or authorisations, when such are needed for the Results in question.

4 EVALUATION OF TENDERS

4.1 Stages of the evaluation

The evaluation of tenders will take place in six successive steps:

- (1) Eligibility stage – verification, on the basis on the conditions defined in Section 4.2, whether the Tenderers (including consortium members and subcontractors) have access to this procurement procedure.
- (2) Exclusion stage – verification, on the basis of the exclusion criteria defined in Section 4.3, whether the Tenderers (including consortium members and subcontractors) are not in a situation of exclusion and can take part in this procurement procedure.
- (3) Compliance with environmental, social and labour laws – verification that the Tenderers comply with environmental, social and labour law requirements of the present procurement procedure, as defined in Section 4.4.
- (4) Selection stage – verification that the Tenderers fulfil the following capacity requirements, as defined in Section 4.5:
 - i. Legal capacity.
 - ii. Economic and financial capacity.
 - iii. Technical and professional capacity.
- (5) Compliance with the minimum requirements - verification that the team members and the technical resources proposed by the Tenderers meet the minimum requirements set out in Section 4.6.
- (6) Evaluation of Tenders on the basis of the award criteria (qualitative and financial) laid down in Section 4.7.

The assessment will be based on the information provided in the Tenders. However, SatCen reserves the right to use any other information from public or specialised sources.

4.2 Access to procurement

4.2.1 Requirement

In order to protect the essential security interest of the EU and its Member States, in accordance with Article 24(2) of the EU Space Programme Regulation, participation to this tender is open to Economic Operators fulfilling the following three cumulative conditions:

- a) Legal entities established in a Member State with their executive management structures established in that Member State.
 - Economic operators are considered to be established in the EU when they are formed in accordance with the law of an EU Member State, and have their central administration, registered office and principal place of business in an EU Member State (if legal persons) or they are nationals of one of the EU Member States (if natural persons).
 - ‘Executive management structure’ means the body of the legal entity appointed in accordance with national law and which, where applicable, reports to the chief executive officer or any other person having comparable decisional power, and which

is empowered to establish the legal entity's strategy, objectives and overall direction, and oversees and monitors management decision-making.

- b) The eligible legal entity commits to carry out all relevant activities in one or more Member States; and
- c) Legal entities not being subject to control by a third country or third country entity. For the purpose of this paragraph 'control' means the ability to exercise a decisive influence over a legal entity directly or indirectly through one or more intermediate legal entities.

These participation conditions shall be met by all participants (tenderers, consortium members and subcontractors) at the moment of submission of the tender and throughout the whole duration of the resulting contract, if awarded, and will be checked by the Contracting Authority at the moment of tender evaluation. In case of any changes related to the compliance with these participation conditions, the Economic Operator, which was awarded a contract, is obliged to inform the Contracting Authority about the changes without delay.

Only offers from participants and meeting the participation conditions laid down in Article 24(2) of the EU Space Programme Regulation will be allowed to the next step of the evaluation (exclusion stage).

Notwithstanding the above, a waiver from the eligibility and participation conditions set out in this Section may be requested for subcontractors (not for tenderers or members of a bidding Group/Consortium). Such requests will be assessed on a case-by-case basis by the European Commission as per Article 24 of the EU Space Programme Regulation.

4.2.2 Evidence required

Tenderers, including members of bidding consortia, and subcontractors, shall prove that they meet the eligibility and participation conditions by providing the Declaration of ownership and control (Appendix H) duly completed, dated and signed.

4.3 Exclusion criteria

4.3.1 Requirement

Participation in this tender procedure is only open to tenderers (all entities involved, including subcontractors and consortium members) that are not in a situation of exclusion as specified in Article 138.1 of Regulation (EU, Euratom) 2024/2509 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of 23 September 2024, on the financial rules applicable to the general budget of the Union (the "EU Financial Regulation"), which includes:

- Bankruptcy and insolvency situations;
- Non-payment of taxes or social security contributions;
- Grave professional misconduct;
- Fraud, corruption, participation in a criminal organisation etc.;
- Serious breach of contract.

4.3.2 Evidence required

Compliance with this requirement must be attested with:

- The Declaration on Honour (Appendix I) duly filled out, dated and signed by the authorised representative of the Tenderer and, if applicable, by the authorised representatives of each member of the bidding consortium and the subcontractors; and
- The evidence supporting the Declaration on Honour of all the entities involved (including consortium members and subcontractors):
 - Extracts from criminal records;
 - Certificates issued by tax administration agencies; and
 - Social security clearance certificates.

The certificates must have been issued no more than one year ago and must still be valid at the time of submission.

In order to help Tenderers identify the official certificates issued in each jurisdiction, please refer to the e-Certis information system, available at: <https://ec.europa.eu/tools/ecertis/#/homePage>

Failure to provide a signed and dated Declaration on Honour may lead to the exclusion from the procurement process.

SatCen reserves the right to request from Tenderers additional evidence supporting their Declaration on Honour. No contract will be signed if the evidence requested is not provided.

SatCen makes use of the Early Detection and Exclusion System (EDES), a centralised database managed by the European Commission, in order to verify whether individuals or organisations are suitable to receive EU funding.

SatCen, as an Entrusted Entity in charge of implementing the EU budget, shall report to the European Commission any risk threatening the Union's financial interests stemming from the grounds of exclusion identified in Article 138.1 of the EU Financial Regulation. Tenderers are expected to cooperate with the SatCen as regards the protection of the financial interests of the EU, by reporting any possible ground of exclusion as listed in Articles 138.1 of the EU Financial Regulation.

4.4 Compliance with environmental, social and labour laws

4.4.1 Requirement

Tenderers must comply with applicable environmental, social and labour law obligations established by European Union law, national legislation, collective agreements or international environmental, social and labour law provisions listed in Annex X of Directive 2014/24/EU.

4.4.2 Evidence required

This requirement must be attested with the Declaration on Honour (Appendix I), duly completed, dated and signed by an authorised representative of the tenderer and, if applicable, by the authorised representatives of each member of the bidding consortium and the subcontractors.

4.5 Selection stage

Only Tenderers that have access to the market, are not in a situation of exclusion and comply with applicable environmental, social and labour laws will be assessed at the selection stage.

Tenderers must fulfil all the legal, economic and financial capacity requirements as well as the technical and professional capacity criteria listed below, in order to pass to the evaluation stage.

Tenderers who do not provide the documentation specified below, or who are judged, on the basis of the documents provided, not to have fulfilled the criteria specified below, will be excluded.

Tenders may be requested to submit further evidence on the exclusion and selection criteria.

4.5.1 Legal capacity

4.5.1.1 Requirement

All the Tenderers, including members of bidding consortia, must prove that they are authorised to perform the Contract under the law of their country of establishment.

4.5.1.2 Evidence required

Tenderers and, if applicable, members of bidding consortia shall prove that they are enrolled in a trade or professional register by providing:

- The Identification Form, duly filled out and signed (see Section 6.b); and
- Certificate of registration supporting that the Tenderer is authorised to perform the contract under national law.

If Economic Operators are not required or entitled to access a trade or professional register for reasons based on their legal status or applicable national legislation, an explanation should be provided and the Contracting Authority may accept, as satisfactory evidence, a sworn declaration, membership of a specific organization, express authorization, or entry in the VAT register, in lieu of the certificate of registration.

4.5.2 Economic and financial capacity

4.5.2.1 Requirement

Tenderers and, if applicable, members of bidding consortia are required to be in a stable financial situation and have sufficient economic and financial capacity to perform the Contract. The Contracting Authority reserves the right not to select a Tenderer where the evidence provided gives rise to major concerns on its financial viability to perform the Contract.

Tenderers must have an average annual turnover equal or greater than eight million Euro (€8,000,000.00) over the last three closed fiscal years.

In the event of joint tendering, a consolidated assessment of all the members of the grouping shall be made.

The Contracting Authority reserves the right not to select a Tenderer where the evidence provided gives rise to major concerns on its financial viability to perform the Contract.

4.5.2.2 Evidence required

Tenderers and, if applicable, members of the bidding consortia are required to submit:

- Profit and loss accounts and balance sheets for the last three years for which accounts have been closed.
- A signed statement as to the average annual turnover in the last three closed fiscal years for which accounts have been closed, as per the form included in Appendix J. In case of joint tendering, a separate statement for each member of the Group and a document summarizing the consolidated data for the grouping as a whole shall be submitted.

4.5.3 Technical and professional capacity

4.5.3.1 Requirements

Tenderers must have at least three (3) years of experience in performing and managing projects in the following fields:

- Production of cartography and graphical representations (visualization) of geospatial data.
- Image processing and analysis used to derive geospatial information from EO data, especially from VHR satellite images.
- GIS to create, manage, analyse, and map different types of data.
- Geospatial data combining location information and attribute information with temporal information.

In the case of joint tendering and/or subcontracting, a consolidated assessment will be made.

4.5.3.2 Evidence required

Evidence required (i): Tenderers shall complete and submit the table below. The table summarises the Tenderer's experience over the past three (3) years in the above-mentioned fields of expertise. It shall indicate:

- Project/contract title and a comprehensive description of the services undertaken.
- Recipient of the services (public or private customers).
- Project duration and value.
- Indication of the proposed team members' (referred to below in this Section) involvement in these projects.

Any other project supporting the Tenderer's experience in the field of the Contract may be added.

Project title	Description	Customer / Funding	Start / End Date	Project value (EUR)	Matching profiles

Table 5 Tenderer's experience in the past three years

In case of joint tendering, the above table should be filled with each Economic Operator forming the bidding consortium.

Should a contract be awarded, the successful Tenderer may be requested by the SatCen to provide the relevant certificates or letters of support attesting completion of the referred projects, duly signed by the relevant authority or client. If a contracting authority or client does not issue such certificates or letters, the Economic Operator should provide written proof of this fact.

Evidence required (ii): In addition to the table above, a description of three (3) of the projects identified in Table 5 shall be provided to illustrate the experience (maximum 1 page per project). If applicable, Tenderers shall indicate details about the methodology followed and workload executed, including the extraction guidelines, total amount of square kilometres analysed, areas mapped, and quality checks performed. At least three members of the proposed production team must have participated in these projects.

4.6 Minimum requirements

4.6.1 Minimum level of qualifications and experience of the proposed team members

The experts identified in Section 2.2 must fulfil the minimum level of qualifications and experience indicated below. All professional experience shall be calculated as of the deadline for submission of tenders.

4.6.1.1 Requirements

- **The Project Manager and the Deputy Project Manager shall each meet the following minimum requirements:**
 - **PM1.** A university degree at Master's level or equivalent (EQF Level 7 or comparable).
 - **PM2.** Minimum of ten (10) years of professional experience in remote sensing, data processing, GIS analysis and digital cartography.
 - **PM3.** Minimum of eight (8) years of professional experience in managing projects involving the delivery of information services and digital cartography products based on EO data and/or GIS analysis.
 - **PM4.** Demonstrated knowledge of recognized project management methodologies (e.g. PRINCE2, PMBOK).
 - **PM5.** Advanced written and verbal communication skills in English (at least C1 level according to the CEFR).
 - **PM6:** Demonstrated thematic knowledge of the use of geospatial information in crisis/security management contexts.
 - **PM7.** Professional experience working with international organisations, including the European Commission and/or its agencies.
- **The proposed Production Coordinator shall meet the following minimum requirements:**
 - **PC1.** A university degree at Bachelor's level or equivalent (EQF Level 6 or comparable).
 - **PC2.** Minimum of seven (7) years of professional experience in remote sensing, data processing, GIS analysis and digital cartography.
 - **PC3.** Minimum of three (3) years of professional experience in managing and supervising production teams delivering information services and digital cartography products based on EO data and/or GIS analysis.
 - **PC4.** Advanced written and verbal communication skills in English (at least C1 level according to the CEFR).
 - **PC5:** Demonstrated thematic knowledge of the use of geospatial information in crisis/security management contexts.
- **The proposed Quality Assurance Manager shall meet the following minimum requirements:**

- **QC1.** A university degree at Bachelor's level or equivalent (EQF Level 6 or comparable).
- **QC2.** Minimum of five (5) years of professional experience in remote sensing, data processing, GIS analysis and digital cartography.
- **QC3.** Minimum of three (3) years of professional experience in quality assurance of projects and geospatial data production, applying recognised international standards and quality assurance procedures in geospatial production environments, including those used in defence and security-related geospatial programmes (e.g. MGCP Extraction Guidance).
- **QC4.** Advanced written and verbal communication skills in English (at least C1 level according to the CEFR).
- **The proposed Earth Observation Specialist shall meet the following minimum requirements:**
 - **EO1.** A university degree at Bachelor's level or equivalent (EQF Level 6 or comparable).
 - **EO2.** Minimum of five (5) years of professional experience in remote sensing image analysis and EO-derived services.
 - **EO3.** Demonstrated professional experience in remote sensing image analysis techniques, including:
 - Use of tools, methodologies and processing algorithms for pre-processing and processing EO satellite data (including optical and SAR).
 - Programming skills (e.g. Python) for processing and automation of EO data workflows.
 - **EO4.** Advanced written and verbal communication skills in English (at least C1 level according to the CEFR).
- **The proposed GIS Analyst shall meet the following minimum requirements:**
 - **GA1.** A university degree at Bachelor's level or equivalent (EQF Level 6 or comparable).
 - **GA2.** Minimum of five (5) years of professional experience in GIS analysis and digital cartography.
 - **GA3.** Demonstrated professional experience in working with GIS technologies and techniques, including:
 - Spatial reference data, including data models, formats and data types.
 - Design and production of visually clear and cartographically sound outputs.
 - Administration and configuration of GIS software platforms (including ESRI ArcGIS suite).
 - Spatial vector data analysis and processing.
 - Configuration of enterprise GIS server environments (including ArcGIS Server).
 - **GA4.** Intermediate written and verbal communication skills in English (at least B2 level according to the CEFR).

- **The proposed Quality Control Supervisor shall meet the following minimum requirements:**
 - **QS1.** A university degree at Bachelor's level or equivalent (EQF Level 6 or comparable).
 - **QS2.** Minimum of three (3) years of professional experience in digital cartography production and/or geospatial data validation.
 - **QS3.** Demonstrated professional experience in quality control and validation of digital cartography and geospatial datasets, including:
 - Review and verification of compliance with cartographic and map production standards.
 - Application of quality assurance procedures in geospatial production environments, including those applied in defence and security-related geospatial programs (e.g. MGCP Extraction Guidance).
 - Identification, documentation and reporting of errors, inconsistencies and non-compliance in geospatial outputs.
 - **QS4.** Intermediate written and verbal communication skills in English (at least B2 level according to the CEFR).
- **The proposed Imagery Analyst shall meet the following minimum requirements:**
 - **IA1.** A university degree at Bachelor's level or equivalent (EQF Level 6 or comparable).
 - **IA2.** Minimum of three (3) years of professional experience in imagery analysis and digital cartography production.
 - **IA3.** Demonstrated professional experience in visual interpretation and feature extraction from EO satellite imagery, including:
 - Identification and delineation of geographic features from EO data.
 - Application of cartographic production principles in geospatial production environments, including those applied in defence and security-related geospatial programs (e.g. MGCP Extraction Guidance).
 - Geospatial data production in intelligence-related contexts, including IMINT, GEOINT and OSINT workflows.
 - **IA4.** Intermediate written and verbal communication skills in English (at least B2 level according to the CEFR).

4.6.1.2 Evidence required (i)

The table below must be duly completed and provided in the tenders. This table indicates the names of the proposed team members and their respective roles in the project and how their qualifications, skills and experience match the technical and professional capacity requirements set out above in this Section.

Project Manager & Deputy Project Manager										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	PM1	PM2	PM3	PM4	PM5	PM6	PM7
...										
Production Coordinator										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	PC1	PC2	PC3	PC4	PC5		
...										
Quality Assurance Manager										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	QC1	QC2	QC3	QC4			
...										
Earth Observation Specialist										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	EO1	EO2	EO3	EO4			
...										
GIS Analyst										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	GA1	GA2	GA3	GA4			
...										
Quality Control Supervisor										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	QS1	QS2	QS3	QS4			
...										
Imagery Analyst										
Team member's name	Contractual relation with the tenderer	Organisation (only in case of consortium)	% of time dedicated to the contract	IA1	IA2	IA3	IA4			
...										

Table 6 Declaration of Team Members' experience

4.6.1.3 Evidence required (ii)

For each proposed expert, Tenderers shall provide a Curriculum Vitae (CV) using the Europass format⁵. The proposed team members can only fulfil one role.

4.6.1.4 Requirement

At the time of the submission of the tenders, the experts proposed for the geospatial production team need to be employees either of the Tenderer, or of the Economic Operators forming the bidding consortium, or of the companies belonging to the same economic Group of the Tenderer or members of the bidding consortium.

4.6.1.5 Evidence required

Should a contract be awarded, the successful Tenderer may be required to provide evidence (e.g. certificate issued by the Economic Operator, individual salary slip or a statement from an official external body, e.g. the taxation office or a social security secretariat) that the team members are indeed employees of the Contractor.

4.6.2 Minimum technical equipment

4.6.2.1 Requirements

Tenderers shall demonstrate access to appropriate equipment to process the Service Request and Orders, fulfil the production required under the FWC, hold videoconferences and deliver the Products to the Contracting Authority in a timely manner. Specifically, Tenderers shall have, at least, the following hardware, software licenses and telecommunications infrastructure:

- Hardware:
 - Adequate hardware resources (including workstations and, where applicable, servers) sufficient to process EO data and produce geospatial outputs in accordance with the technical specifications and delivery timeliness of the FWC.
- Software licenses for:
 - Satellite imagery processing and analysis.
 - Cartographic production (ArcGIS Pro).
 - Remote videoconferencing (e.g. Microsoft Teams or equivalent).
 - Issue tracking and technical coordination (e.g. JIRA Service Desk, Slack, Flock or equivalent).
- Network and telecommunications infrastructure: Tenderers shall ensure secure and efficient electronic transfer of deliverables and remote collaboration capabilities, including:
 - Sufficient and stable Internet connectivity to organise and participate in remote meetings, including videoconferencing with audio, video and screen-sharing functionality.
 - Internet connectivity supporting a minimum symmetrical bandwidth of 100 Mbps for both upload and download, suitable for the transfer of geospatial datasets and participation in remote collaboration activities.
 - Provision, management and maintenance of secure file transfer infrastructure, including:
 - An SFTP server with a minimum available storage capacity of 3 TB, as a primary delivery method. The Contractor shall ensure the availability of additional storage

⁵ <https://europass.cedefop.europa.eu/en/documents/curriculum-vitae>

resources whenever necessary to accommodate peak workloads, multiple concurrent deliveries, and large-volume geospatial datasets without disruption to the Service

- An alternative secure delivery solution providing equivalent security and reliability and ensuring service continuity in the event of failure or unavailability of the primary SFTP server.

4.6.2.2 Evidence required

Tenderers shall provide a description of the available technical resources (including hardware, software and telecommunications infrastructure) to fulfil the production required under the Contract. The description shall include, at a minimum:

- The number of available PCs and/or workstations dedicated to the performance of the Contract.
- The type of available software, including the number of licenses and software versions.
- The network and telecommunications infrastructure supporting the primary SFTP solution and the alternative secure delivery method.
- A description of the alternative delivery method, including its hosting arrangements and security features.

The tables below shall be duly completed and submitted as part of the Tender:

Hardware equipment			
Units	Equipment	Version	Description

Table 7. Hardware Equipment

Software licenses			
Units	Software	Version	Description

Table 8. Software licenses

Network and telecommunications infrastructure			
Units	Equipment	Version	Description

Table 9. Network and telecommunications infrastructure

4.7 Award criteria

4.7.1 Technical evaluation

The technical quality of the tender (Quality Score - QS) will be assessed on the basis of the tenderer's Technical Proposal. The Technical Proposals shall be evaluated exclusively against the award criteria set out below in this Section.

The maximum Quality Score is **70 points**. In order to be considered for the financial evaluation, the tenders must achieve:

- A minimum score of 40 points in the quality assessment, and

- The minimum score(s) per criterion, and where applicable per sub-criterion, as specified in the table below.

Criterion Q1: Adequacy and comprehensiveness of the results of the case Scenarios (Appendix E)		
Sub-criteria	Maximum Score: 26 points	Minimum Score: 18 points⁶
1.1. Case Scenario 1	6/26	4/26
1.1.1. Capacity to identify and process information from different data types and sources.	2/6	
1.1.2. Capacity to make image analysis in wide areas.	2/6	
1.1.3. Quality of the provided dataset.	2/6	
1.2. Case Scenario 2	6/26	4/26
1.2.1. Description of tasks	2/6	
1.2.2. Workload optimization and distribution criteria.	2/6	
1.2.3. Description of personnel involved (roles / number)	1/6	
1.2.4. Schedule of deliverables	1/6	
1.3. Case Scenario 3	7/26	5/26
1.3.1. Identification of Layers required for this product.	2/7	
1.3.2. Implementation of structure required and topologic rules to support Network Analysis.	2/7	
1.3.3. Quality of the provided routes.	3/7	
1.4. Case Scenario 4	7/26	5/26
1.4.1. Capacity to identify relevant elements associated with industrial activity and dumping of industrial waste.	2/7	
1.4.2. Clarity of the final report (e.g. overall activity, assessment of the task, main findings, relevant information in the imagery, open-source information and pictures).	2/7	
1.4.3. Quality of the provided dataset.	3/7	

Table 10 Criterion Q1: Adequacy and comprehensiveness of the results of the case Scenarios (Appendix E)

Criterion Q2: Technical relevance of the proposed solutions for the supply of geospatial products		
Sub-criteria	Maximum Score: 20 points	Minimum Score: 10 points
2.1. Adequacy of the proposed production workflow, including the procedures and methodologies for the production and supply of Products, both in standard and urgent mode.	8/20	4/20
2.2. Adequacy of the proposed strategy to conduct advanced analysis to complement the different Product types, covering a description of the remote sensing techniques and the geospatial analytical methods applied.	6/20	3/20

⁶ The minimum scores indicated for each Case Scenario apply to the overall score of the respective Scenario. No minimum score applies to the individual sub-elements within each Scenario.

2.3. Adequacy of the proposed solutions for the adaptation of the Product specifications if the input imagery's spatial resolution to be used for production is greater than 1 meter (e.g. IIRC2, IIRC3 or IIRC4).	6/20	3/20
--	------	------

Table 11 Criterion Q2: Technical relevance of the proposed solutions for the supply of geospatial products

Criterion Q3: Quality of project management		
Sub-criteria	Maximum Score: 24 points	Minimum Score: 12 points
3.1. Relevance of the proposed team members' competencies and suitability to their role in the project. (i.e. breakdown of tasks: what profiles will do what task). In case of joint tenders, coordination strategy and suitability of the allocation of tasks among consortium members.	8/24	4/24
3.2. Suitability of the proposed strategy to ensure the timeliness, consistency and homogeneity among Products, including the setting up of a quality management plan, workflows to ensure the highest quality of the Products, and the usage of adequate communication tools.	8/24	4/24
3.3. Relevance of the key performance indicators proposed to ensure and monitor timeliness and quality of all Services and Products requested.	4/24	2/24
3.4. Adequacy of the proposed risk management plan (identification, monitoring, and assessment of risks during the project phases and proposed mitigation strategy, particularly regarding timely compliance).	4/24	2/24

Table 12 Criterion Q3: Quality of project management

The total Quality Score (QS) shall be calculated as follows:

$$QS = Q1 + Q2 + Q3$$

Where Q1, Q2 and Q3 represent the scores obtained for each respective criterion.

4.7.2 Financial Evaluation

The financial evaluation shall be based exclusively on the prices proposed in the Economic Offer, submitted in accordance with Appendix C - Economic Offer Template. The maximum score for the financial evaluation is **30 points**.

Tenders exceeding the maximum price established for the Fixed Part and/or the Variable Parts as set out in Appendix C, shall be rejected as non-compliant and shall not be further evaluated, being therefore excluded from the rest of the evaluation procedure.

The Financial Score (FS) shall be calculated as the sum of the financial scores obtained for the Fixed Part of the FWC and for each Product Type, in accordance with the formula and weighting set out in the table below:

Financial Criteria	Category	Maximum points per category
F1	Fixed part: Monthly price in euro for the tasks described in Section 2.1.1 (ensuring the availability of the production team, management and coordination)	10
F2	Variable part: Product Types Price in euro to produce the following new Products in standard mode, as described in Appendix A – Technical Specifications I. ○ First Impression Report ○ Briefing Note ○ Digital Geographic Information ○ Mapbook ○ Country Map Coverage	15
F3	Variable part: Temporal Complexity and Advanced Analysis Price in euro to perform the complementary temporal complexity and advanced analysis as described in Appendix A - Technical Specifications I: ○ Augmented Temporal Complexity ○ Advanced Analysis ○ Advanced Analysis – High Complexity	5

Table 13 Maximum points per category to be obtained in the financial evaluation

The prices quoted in the Economic Offer, as per Appendix C, shall be evaluated and scored in accordance with the formulas and weighting factors specified below.

Scores shall be calculated to two decimal places.

4.7.2.1 Fixed Part (F1)

The score for the price proposed for all tasks associated to the Fixed Part (F1) of the FWC shall be calculated as follows:

$$F1 = \frac{P_{fix_min}}{P_{fix}} \times 10$$

Where:

- **F1:** Financial score awarded for the Fixed Part (maximum 10 points).
- **P_{fix_min} :** The lowest price for the fixed part of the FWC among all tenders admitted to the financial evaluation stage, in EUR.
- **P_{fix} :** The price offered by the tenderer for the fixed part, in EUR.

4.7.2.2 Variable Part: Product Types (F2)

The prices for the five (5) Product Types shall be evaluated using the weighting factors indicated in the table below:

Product	Price of the Products (P_{pt_i})	Evaluation Weighting Factor (W_i)
First Impression Report	P_{pt_1}	$W_1 = 0,25$
Briefing Note	P_{pt_2}	$W_2 = 0,20$
Digital Geographic Information	P_{pt_3}	$W_3 = 0,25$
Mapbook	P_{pt_4}	$W_4 = 0,20$
Country Map Coverage	P_{pt_5}	$W_5 = 0,10$

Table 14 Weighting factors applicable to prices quoted for the Variable part: Product Types

The total financial score for the Variable Part (F2) shall be calculated as follows:

$$G_i = \frac{P_{pt_min_i}}{P_{pt_i}} \times 15$$

Where:

- i : Index identifying the Product Type, with $i=1$ (First Impression Report – FIR), $i=2$ (Briefing Note – BN), $i=3$ (Digital Geographic Information – DGI), $i=4$ (Mapbook – MB) and $i=5$ (Country Map Coverage – CMC).
- G_i : Financial score awarded for Product Type i , expressed in points.
- $P_{pt_min_i}$: Lowest price offered for Product Type i , among tenders admitted to the financial evaluation staged, expressed in EUR.
- P_{pt_i} : Price offered by the tenderer for Product Type i , expressed in EUR.

The total score for the financial evaluation of the five (5) Product Types shall be as the following weighted sum:

$$F2 = \sum_{i=1}^5 (G_i \times W_i)$$

Where:

- **F2**: Total financial score for the Variable Part, expressed in points. F2 may range from 0 to 15 points.
- W_i : Weighting factor applicable to Product Type i , as defined in Table 14.

4.7.2.3 Variable Part: Temporal Complexity and Advanced Analysis (F3)

The prices quoted for the Temporal Complexity and Advanced Analysis shall be evaluated using the weighting factors set out in the table below.

Product	Pricing of parameter (P_{AA_j})	Evaluation Weighting Factor (W_j)
Augmented Temporal Complexity	P_{AA_1}	$W_1 = 0,3$
Advanced Analysis	P_{AA_2}	$W_2 = 0,4$
Advanced Analysis – High Complexity	P_{AA_3}	$W_3 = 0,3$

Table 15 Weighting factors applicable to prices quoted for the Complementary Advanced Analysis products

The score for each category shall be calculated as follows:

$$M_j = \frac{P_{AA_min_j}}{P_{AA_j}} \times 5$$

Where:

- **j** : Index identifying the Temporal Complexity / Advanced Analysis Category, with **$j=1$** (Augmented Temporal Complexity), **$j=2$** (Advanced Analysis) and **$j=3$** (Advanced Analysis – High Complexity).
- **M_j** : Financial score awarded for Advanced Analysis category **j** , expressed in points.
- **$P_{AA_min_j}$** : Lowest price offered for category **j** among tenders admitted to the financial evaluation stage, expressed in EUR.
- **P_{AA_j}** : Price offered by the tenderer for category **j** , expressed in EUR.

The total financial score for the Temporal Complexity / Advanced Analysis categories shall be calculated as:

$$F3 = \sum_{j=1}^3 (M_j \times W_j)$$

Where:

- **$F3$** : Total financial score for the Temporal Complexity / Advanced Analysis category (maximum 5 points).
- **W_j** : Weighting factor per category **j** , as defined in Table 15.

4.7.2.4 Total Financial Score

For each tender, the Financial Score (FS) shall be calculated by summing the scores obtained for the Fixed Part (F1), the Variable Part – Product Types (F2), and the Variable Part – Temporal Complexity / Advanced Analysis (F3), in accordance with the following formula:

$$FS = F1 + F2 + F3$$

4.7.3 Award (ranking of tenders)

The tenders shall be ranked from the highest to the lowest Final Score, calculated as follows:

$$TS = QS + FS$$

Where:

- **TS** : Total Score (maximum 100 points).
- **QS** : Quality Score (maximum 70 points).
- **FS** : Financial Score (maximum 30 points).

The maximum Total Score is 100 points.

The Framework Contract (FWC) shall be awarded to the tenderer whose tender obtains the highest Total Score.

In the event of a tie in the Total Score, the tender with the highest Quality Score shall be ranked first. If the tie persists, the tender with the highest score for Criterion Q2 shall be ranked first. If the tie persists, the tender with the lowest Financial Offer shall be ranked first.

5 ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION CONCERNING THE INVITATION TO TENDER

5.1 Applicable rules

This procurement procedure is governed by the following provisions:

- Regulation (EU, Euratom) 2024/2509 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of 23 September 2024, on the financial rules applicable to the general budget of the Union (the “EU Financial Regulation”).
- Regulation (EU) 2021/696 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of 28 April 2021, establishing the Union Space Programme and the European Union Agency for the Space Programme and repealing Regulations (EU) No 912/2010, (EU) No 1285/2013 and (EU) No 377/2014 and Decision No 541/2014/EU (the “EU Space Programme Regulation”).
- SatCen’s public procurement manual, available at:

https://www.satcen.europa.eu/keydocuments/Procurement%20Manual_V69a05f39ac32d3200f35bb01.06.pdf

5.2 No obligation to award

Completing the procedure of this call for tenders in no way imposes on the SatCen an obligation to award the contract. SatCen shall not be liable for any compensation with respect to tenderers whose offers have not been accepted, nor shall SatCen be liable when deciding not to award the Contract.

The SatCen will not reimburse expenses incurred in preparing and submitting tenders.

Once the SatCen has accepted the tender, it shall become the property of SatCen and the SatCen shall treat it confidentially.

Variants are not allowed.

5.3 Misrepresentation and corruptive practices

The Contract shall not be awarded to tenderers who, during the procurement procedure:

- a) are subject to a conflict of interest;
- b) are guilty of misrepresentation in supplying the information required by SatCen as a condition of participation in the contract award procedure or fail to supply this information;
- c) attempt to obtain confidential information, enter into unlawful agreements with competitors or influence the evaluation committee or SatCen’s staff members or Directors during the process of examining, clarifying, evaluating and comparing tenders.

All the above-mentioned circumstances shall lead to the rejection of an offer and may result in administrative penalties.

5.4 Tender calendar

The Tender calendar, as currently envisaged, incorporates the following key dates:

Milestone	Date / Deadline
Launch of the procedure (dispatch of contract notice)	04-09-2026
Closing date for receiving questions	09-10-2026
Closing date for the submission of tenders	29-10-2026 (at 16:00 h CET)
Opening session	30-10-2026 (at 12:00 h CET)
Estimated communication of evaluation results	04-12-2026
Estimated date of contract signature	15-12-2026

Table 16 Tender calendar

5.5 Subcontracting

Tenderers shall indicate in Appendix F - Tender Submission Form the activities they intend to subcontract and the details of the proposed subcontractors. Where the subcontractors cannot be clearly identified at the time of submission, the Tenderer shall provide a list of potential subcontractors.

The Contractor shall not engage subcontractors other than those identified in the Tender without the prior written authorization of the Contracting Authority.

Subcontracting shall be permitted provided that it does not concern the following core activities:

- All tasks related to the fixed part of the Contract.
- Core activities of the variable part of the Contract which comprises the production and supply of Products.

Subcontractors shall provide a signed letter of intent (free format) confirming their participation in the event of award of the Contract.

The identified subcontractors shall guarantee the application of the same quality standards, quality assurance and risk management procedures as those applied by the Contractor.

Tasks provided for in the Contract may be entrusted to subcontractors; however, the Contractor shall retain full liability towards SatCen for the performance of the Contract as a whole.

Accordingly:

- SatCen shall deal exclusively with the Contractor in all contractual matters (including payments), irrespective of whether tasks are performed by subcontractors;
- SatCen shall maintain direct contact primarily with the Contractor, who remains responsible for the execution of the Contract;
- Under no circumstances shall the Contractor be relieved of liability towards SatCen on the grounds that a subcontractor is at fault. The Contractor shall remain fully responsible, in particular for timely performance.

Subcontractors shall not further subcontract any part of the tasks entrusted to them.

Contracts involving subcontracting shall be subject to the relevant provisions of the Contract, in particular those relating to subcontracting, checks and audits, and confidentiality. SatCen may require the submission of a confidentiality declaration signed by the subcontractor(s).

The subcontracting arrangements between the Contractor and its subcontractor(s) shall ensure that all relevant contractual obligations towards SatCen are directly applicable to the subcontractor(s).

Tenderers shall inform the subcontractor(s) accordingly and shall include in their subcontracting agreements a reference to the applicability of Articles II.8, II.13 and II.22 of the Contract to the subcontractor(s).

All subcontractors shall meet the exclusion criteria established in Section 4.3.

An economic operator may participate as subcontractor in more than one proposal. Moreover, an economic operator may act as a subcontractor in a distinct bid from which it participates as either sole tenderer, leader in a joint tender or partner in a joint tender.

5.6 Participation of consortia

Tenders may be submitted by a consortium of two or more Economic Operators ("joint tender"). Each Economic Operator forming the Consortium shall, in the event of award, become a party to the Contract and shall assume joint and several liability towards the Contracting Authority for the performance of the Contract.

SatCen shall not require consortia to adopt a specific legal form for the purpose of submitting a Tender. However, SatCen reserves the right to require the Consortium to adopt a particular legal form prior to signature of the Contract, where such form is necessary for the proper performance of the Contract.

The Consortium shall designate one member as Consortium Leader. The Consortium Leader shall be responsible for:

- Receiving and processing payments on behalf of all Consortium members.
- Managing the administrative aspects of the services.
- Coordinating the performance of the Contract on behalf of the Consortium.

The Tender and, in the event of award, the FWC shall be signed by all Consortium members. Alternatively, the members may grant a power of attorney to one member (e.g. the Consortium Leader) authorising it to submit the Tender and, where applicable, to sign the FWC on behalf of all members. In such case, the duly completed and signed power of attorney, in accordance with the template provided in Appendix G, shall be included in the Tender.

The power of attorney shall be dated and signed by the authorised representatives of all Consortium members.

The composition of the Consortium shall not be altered during the performance of the Contract. After contract award, no Consortium member may be replaced without the prior written authorisation of the Contracting Authority and without the new member having acceded to the Contract.

Partners submitting a joint tender shall remain jointly and severally liable towards SatCen for the performance of the Contract as a whole.

All Consortium members shall meet the exclusion criteria set out in Section 4.3.

An economic operator can only participate once as a tenderer, whether as sole tenderer, leader in a joint tender or partner in a joint tender.

5.7 EU Funding

The FWC is funded by a financial contribution effected by the European Commission under the Contribution Agreement for the implementation of the Copernicus Security service component in Support to EU External and Security Actions.

5.8 Opportunities for small and medium sized enterprises

The EU Space Programme Regulation promotes the widest and most open participation possible in procurement procedures of all Economic Operators throughout the EU, in particular start-ups, new entrants and SMEs.

In this context, **start-ups, new entrants and SMEs are particularly encouraged to submit tenders** either on their own, if feasible, by constituting a joint bid (Consortium or Group) or participating as subcontractors.

5.9 Subsequent contracts with the same contractor

Within three years of contract signature, the SatCen reserves the right to launch an exceptional negotiated procedure for similar services (e.g. the services described in Section 2 of this document) with the awarded tenderer in case of need, according to Point 11.1 (e) of Annex 1 of the EU Financial Regulation. The maximum value of such additional similar services shall not exceed thirty per cent (30%) of the original contract value.

6 SUBMISSION VIA THE E-SUBMISSION APPLICATION

Tenderers shall submit their Tenders electronically via e-Submission, preferably in English before the closing date for submission of tenders as described in the Invitation to Tender.

Rules regarding the submission of Tenders are provided in the Invitation to Tender.

Tenderers must observe precisely the indications provided in the Invitation to Tender in order to ensure their tenders are admissible.

Late delivery will lead to the non-admissibility of the Tender and its rejection from the award procedure for this contract.

Tenderers must submit the following documents using e-Submission:

a) The Tender submission form, provided in Appendix F, duly completed and signed by the authorised representative of the tenderer or Consortium Leader.

b) The Identification Form, available at: [Identification Form](#)

The Identification Form must be completed, dated and signed by the Tenderer's authorised representative and, if applicable, by all the participating entities, including members of bidding consortia. Moreover, the Identification Form must be duly signed and dated by the Tenderer's (or consortium leader's) banker.

The Identification Form must be accompanied by all the supporting documents requested therein (copies of register(s) of companies, official gazette, vat registration, etc.).

c) The Declaration of ownership and control (Appendix H), duly completed, dated and signed by the Tenderer's authorised representative and, if applicable, by the authorised representatives of all the participating entities, including members of bidding consortia and subcontractors.

d) The Declaration on Honour relating to exclusion and selection criteria using the template provided in Appendix I.

The Declaration on Honour must be completed, dated and signed by the tenderer's representative and, if applicable, by all the participating entities, including members of bidding consortia and subcontractors.

e) The evidence supporting the Declaration on Honour of all the entities involved (including consortium members and subcontractors):

- Extracts from criminal records.
- Certificates issued by tax administration agencies.
- Social security clearance certificates.

The certificates must have been issued no more than one year ago and must still be valid at the time of submission.

In order to help Tenderers identify the official certificates issued in each jurisdiction, please refer to the e-Certis information system, available at: <https://ec.europa.eu/tools/ecertis/#/homePage>

f) The power of attorney (or delegation, notice of appointment, trade register excerpt, articles of association, by-laws or equivalent) for the purpose of signing and submitting the Tender, any documents related to this call for tenders and any contract that may result from this procedure.

Additionally, in case of joint bidding, the power of attorney in favour of the Consortium Leader (Appendix G), authorising one of its members (e.g. the leader of the grouping/consortium) to submit a tender and sign the resulting contract on behalf of the other consortium members, must be signed by all the members of the grouping/consortium.

g) A letter of intent (free format), duly signed and dated by the subcontractor's representative, confirming the subcontractors' participation if the Contract is awarded (only in case of subcontracting), as required in Section 5.5.

h) The evidence of tenderer's economic and financial capacity, as required in Section 4.5.2:

- i. Profit and loss accounts and balance sheets for the past three fiscal years for which accounts have been closed.
- ii. A signed statement as to the average annual turnover in the last three closed fiscal years, as per the form attached as Appendix J.

i) The evidence of tenderer's technical and professional capacity, as required in Section 4.5.3:

- i. Table 5 - Tenderer's experience - duly filled out.
- ii. A description of three (3) of the projects identified in Table 5 (1 page per project maximum).

j) The evidence of compliance with the minimum requirements, as set out in Section 4.6:

- i. Table 6 - Declaration of Team Members' experience - duly filled out.
- ii. The CVs of the proposed team members in Europass format.
- iii. Table 7, Table 8 and Table 9 – Description of the available technical resources – duly completed.

k) Technical proposal.

Tenders shall include a technical proposal addressing all aspects detailed in Section 2 and demonstrating a good understanding of the technical specifications (Appendixes A and B).

The length of the technical offer should not exceed 200 pages in A4 format, Calibri 11, single spaced.

The technical proposal, as well as the present Tender Specifications, shall be an integral part of the Contract and will constitute an annex to the FWC.

The technical proposal should address all matters laid down in these Tender Specifications and provide, as a minimum, all the information needed for evaluating the Tender's quality based on the award criteria set out in Section 4.7.1. Incompleteness of this Section can only result in a negative impact in the evaluation of award criteria. Please note also, that proposals deviating from the technical specifications will be rejected for non-conformity.

Tenderers shall elaborate on all points addressed in these specifications in order to score as many points as possible. The mere repetition of mandatory requirements set out in the Tender specifications, without providing further details or added value, may result in a lower score. In addition, if certain essential points of the specifications are not expressly covered by the Tender, SatCen may decide to give a zero mark for the relevant qualitative award criteria.

Technical proposals must be structured following the order of the award criteria in Section 4.7.1 and must include a matrix indicating the page or section of the proposal addressing the award criteria in, as per the table below:

	Page or Section
Q1	
Q2	
Q3	

Table 17 Technical Proposal – Identification of Sections of the Proposal relating to the Award Criteria

- **Information needed for evaluating criterion Q1 (adequacy and comprehensiveness of the results of the case scenarios):**

The results of the scenarios shall be included in the technical proposal as per the instructions provided in Appendix E – Scenarios.

It is the tenderer's responsibility to send a USB data-storage device containing the files (use of express courier is highly recommended), in GIS format (such as MXD or GDB) used for elaborating the scenarios, before the closing date for the submission of tenders, as established in Section 5.4 of this document, to the following address:

European Union Satellite Centre
 Avenida de Cádiz, Ed. 457
 Base Aérea de Torrejón
 E-28850 Torrejón de Ardoz
 Madrid, Spain
 For the attention of Adrian Sanchez
 Contact phone number for delivery: +34 91 678 60 93

Tenderers are requested to inform SatCen of the details of the dispatch (date, courier service and tracking number) by sending an email to procurement.satcen@satcen.europa.eu.

- **Information needed for evaluating criterion Q2 (technical relevance of the proposed solutions for the supply of geospatial products):**

This part of the technical proposal shall include a comprehensive explanation of the methodology to accomplish the tasks defined in Section 2.1.2.

The following elements shall be identified:

- Proposed methodology for the production workflow step-by-step, including planning and preparation, identification and extraction of features and generation of geospatial outputs. This analysis should assume that the spatial resolution of the imagery is less than 1 meter. In addition, the analysis should consider the work both under the standard and urgent modes.
- Description and methodological approach for temporal complexity analysis and the use of advanced analysis techniques as defined in Appendix A – Technical Specifications I.
- Description and methodological approach of the adaptation of the product specifications if the Input Imagery Spatial Resolution to be used for the production is greater than 1 meter (e.g., IIRC2, IIRC3 or IIRC4).

- **Information needed for evaluating criterion Q3 (quality of project management):**

Tenders must include an outline of project management plan, aiming to ensure due compliance with expected delivery times and quality levels. This outline should at least cover:

- i. Team proposed for the implementation of the FWC, including a description of the team members' competencies and suitability to their role in the project. (i.e., breakdown of tasks: what profiles will do what task). In case of joint Tenders, coordination strategy and suitability of the allocation of tasks among consortium members.
- ii. Strategy proposed to ensure the timeliness, consistency and homogeneity among products, including a quality management plan, with a clear description of the quality assurance standards and procedures as well as the usage of adequate communication tools. It should include production quality checks to be applied to the different inputs and outputs of the service, including rules, benchmarks, and tools.
- iii. Monitoring of production progress and KPIs proposed for measuring the FWC's success and reporting strategy.
- iv. Risk Management Plan (identification, monitoring, and assessment of risks during the project phases and proposed mitigation strategy, particularly regarding timely compliance). The Risk Management Plan must include at least a risk map, indicating the potential risks (technical, operational, managerial, etc.) that may appear during Contract execution, their likelihood, their expected impact, the most adequate mitigation strategy, and specific actions to prevent, remedy or limit such risks.

I) Financial proposal:

Tenderers are required to submit their financial proposals by filling in and signing the tables included in Appendix C – Economic Offer:

- i. Table 1 (economic offer for the fixed part of the Contract); and
- ii. Tables 2 to 5 (economic offer for the variable part of the Contract).

The economic offer is binding on the tenderer, and the proposed prices will be considered as the unit prices of the FWC.

Tenderer's attention is drawn to the following points:

- i. Prices shall not be subject to an upward revision during the term of the FWC and its renewal.
- ii. Prices shall be expressed in euro.
- iii. The price quoted shall be all inclusive, namely reflecting all direct and indirect costs relating to the performance of the FWC (including, without limitations, travel, accommodations, subsistence expenses, contract management and overheads).
- iv. Prices should be quoted free of all duties, taxes and other charges, i.e. also free of VAT.
- v. Prices shall not be conditional and be directly applicable.
- vi. The total amount of the tender to be inserted in the relevant tab of e-Submission shall be EUR 0.01 for technical submission purposes only. The financial proposal submitted in accordance with Appendix C shall be the only amount considered for the financial evaluation.

The Financial Proposal shall be complete, clear and unconditional. Tenders may be rejected as non-compliant if the Financial Proposal contains statements or reservations that prevent an accurate and complete financial assessment (e.g. “to be discussed”, “subject to conditions”, “depending on X”, or similar wording).

m) Tender Submission Report – generated by e-Submission.

Please note that to ensure equal treatment of all tenderers it is not possible to modify offers after their submission in relation to the technical and financial proposals.

Incomplete financial or technical proposals may have a considerable negative impact the evaluation on award criteria.

The SatCen will reject Tenders where no technical offers or financial offers are proposed.

Non-compliance with the minimum requirements in Section 4.6 may also result in rejection from award.

The SatCen reserves the right, however, to request clarifications of the Tender after the opening. It may furthermore require (additional) evidence in relation to the administrative information, exclusion and selection criteria. The information required shall be provided within the time-limit stipulated.

7 APPENDICES

Appendix A - Technical Specifications I

Appendix B –Technical Specifications II (limited distribution)

Appendix C - Economic Offer Template

Appendix D - Calculation of the Total Price and Production Time of Orders

Appendix E - Scenarios

Appendix F - Tender Submission Form

Appendix G - Power of Attorney in Favour of the Consortium Leader

Appendix H - Declaration of ownership and control

Appendix I - Declaration on Honour

Appendix J - Statement of Average Annual Turnover

Appendix K - Non-Disclosure Undertaking